

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP): Resetting the API Gateway Cache

Purpose

This document provides instructions for safely flushing the API Gateway cache in staging and production environments when configuration changes or data updates fail to reflect downstream.

 **Warning:** Flushing the production cache causes a temporary spike in database read traffic. Avoid performing this during peak traffic hours (14:00–18:00 UTC).

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Locate the API Gateway Service

1. Log into the **Cloud Console** and verify your active environment (Staging or Production) in the top-right menu.
2. In the left navigation menu, click **API Management > Gateways**.
3. Search for the affected service using its **Service ID** and click on its name.

Step 2: Execute the Cache Flush

Choose **one** of the methods below to clear the cache:

- **Method A: Cloud Console UI**

1. Click the **Settings** tab.
2. Scroll to the **Cache Configuration** section and click **Flush Cache**.
3. Type CONFIRM-FLUSH in the pop-up modal and click **Proceed**.

- **Method B: Command Line Interface (CLI)**

1. Open your terminal and log in:

```
cloud-cli login --user=username
```

2. Run the purge command (replace `[service-id]` with your actual service ID):

```
``bash
cloud-cli gateway cache purge --service-id=[service-id] --force
```

Step 3: Verify System Health

Navigate to the **Metrics & Logs** tab and monitor system behavior against these thresholds for 5 minutes:

- **Database Load:** Must remain below 75% CPU utilization.
- **API Latency:** Must remain under 200ms.

Troubleshooting

If latency exceeds 500ms or database CPU utilization tops 90%, immediately page the On-Call Reliability Engineer via Slack at #ops-alerts.

